Enhancement of Permanently Shadowed Regions (PSR) of Lunar Craters

Captured by OHRC aboard Chandrayaan-2

A Complete CSE Project Guide:
Data Science · Machine Learning · Deep Learning · Computer Vision

Organisation: Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
Instrument: OHRC – Chandrayaan-2 Orbiter
Data: PDS4 Panchromatic Images (0.25 m resolution)
Domain: Low-Light Image Enhancement (LLIE)
Category: Software / Deep Learning

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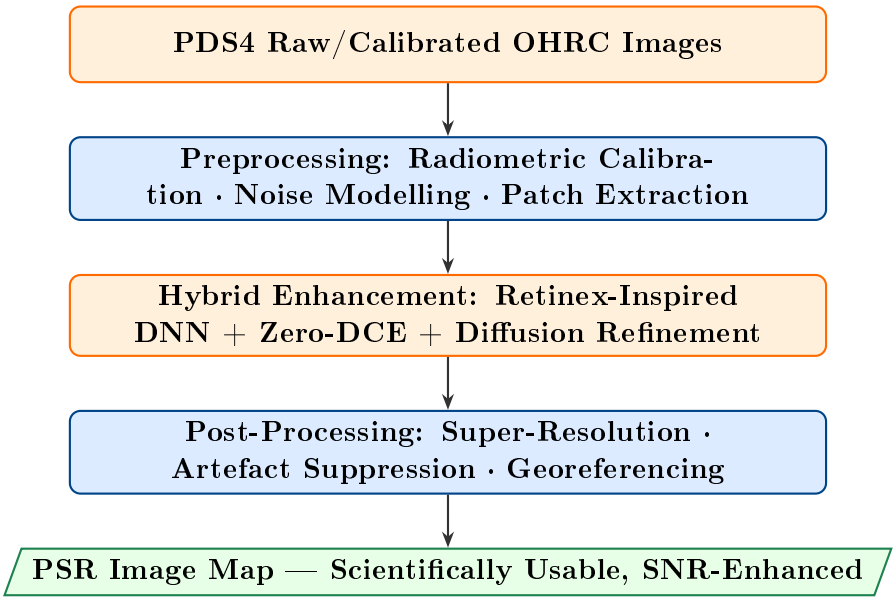
Executive Summary

What This Document Is

This guide is a *complete engineering-science textbook* for building a **Low-Light Image Enhancement (LLIE)** system for Permanently Shadowed Regions (PSR) of the lunar poles, using panchromatic imagery from the **Orbiter High Resolution Camera (OHRC)** aboard ISRO's Chandrayaan-2. It covers every layer—from raw PDS4 data ingestion to a deployed inference pipeline—with full mathematical derivations, deep-learning architecture blueprints, code skeletons, and evaluation protocols.

The Core Problem in One Sentence: PSR floors receive *no direct sunlight*; the OHRC captures near-black images with SNR $\ll 1$, yet these regions may hold water ice critical to future lunar missions—we need software that recovers scientifically usable detail from this noise-dominated signal.

Our Solution Stack:



Chapter 1

Understanding the Problem Domain

1.1 Permanently Shadowed Regions — Why They Matter

The Moon's obliquity to the ecliptic is only $\approx 1.54°$. This means craters near the poles have floors that *never* see direct sunlight—these are the **Permanently Shadowed Regions (PSRs)**.

Key Physical Facts about PSRs

- Surface temperatures in PSR floors: **29–89 K** (Faustini crater, measured by LRO Diviner).
- At these temperatures, water ice is thermodynamically stable for *geological timescales* ($> 10^9$ years).
- The LCROSS impact at Cabeus confirmed **several% water by volume** at 6–10 m depth.
- Faustini (87.23°S, 83.54°E) is a **41 km wide** crater—the third-largest PSR on the Moon and one of 13 Artemis III candidate landing sites.

1.1.1 Illumination Physics in a PSR

Even inside a PSR, a *tiny* amount of photons reach the floor via:

1. **Secondary scattering**: sunlit crater walls scatter $\sim 10^{-4}$ of direct flux onto the floor.
2. **Earthshine**: reflected sunlight from Earth ($\sim 0.14\,\mathrm{W\,m^{-2}}$ at the Moon's surface).
3. **Starlight / zodiacal light**: negligible but non-zero.

The effective radiance incident on an OHRC detector pixel inside a PSR is therefore:

Incident Radiance Model

$$L_{\text{PSR}} = \rho_{\text{floor}} \left[\underbrace{f_s \, L_{\odot} \, \Omega_{\text{wall}}}_{\text{scattered sunlight}} + \underbrace{L_{\text{Earth}}, \Omega_{\text{Earth}}}_{\text{Earthshine}} + \underbrace{L_{\text{zod}}}_{\text{zodiacal}} \right] \tag{1.1}$$

where ρ_{floor} is the floor albedo (~ 0.07 for lunar regolith), $f_s \sim 10^{-4}$ is the wall scattering fraction, and Ω are solid angles. In practice $L_{\text{PSR}} \approx 10^{-4}$, L_{sunlit} .

1.2 The OHRC Instrument

OHRC Specifications (from the User Guide)

Parameter	Value
Sensor type	Passive electro-optical (panchromatic)
Spectral band	500–800 nm
Ground Sampling Distance	**0.25 m / pixel**
Orbit altitude	100 km × 100 km circular
Data type	UnsignedByte (8-bit, 0–255)
Image dimensions	Up to 54860 × 12000 pixels
Archive format	PDS4 (.img + .xml label)

The critical implication: in a PSR, a sunlit crater wall may yield pixel values of 150–255, while the PSR floor yields values of **1–10 out of 255**. This is a dynamic range challenge of $>$ **25** dB.

1.3 Why Standard Methods Fail

Method	Why It Fails for PSR	Artefact Introduce
Histogram Equalisation	Amplifies read noise equally with signal	Grainy noise floor
Gamma Correction	Single global parameter; ignores spatial context	Washed-out walls
CLAHE	Tile size hard to tune; over-enhances flat regions	Block artefacts
Simple Denoising (median)	Blurs real topographic features	Loss of crater rim de
Classical Retinex	No noise model; fails at very low SNR	Halo / ringing

1.4 Problem Statement Formalisation

Formal Problem Definition

Let $\mathbf{I} \in [0, 255]^{H \times W}$ be the raw OHRC image. We model it as:

$$\mathbf{I} = \mathbf{S} \odot \mathbf{R} + \mathbf{N} \tag{1.2}$$

where:

- $\mathbf{S} \in [0, 1]^{H \times W}$ — illumination map (Retinex decomposition)
- $\mathbf{R} \in [0, 1]^{H \times W}$ — reflectance map (intrinsic scene albedo)
- $\mathbf{N}$ — noise (mixed Poisson–Gaussian in low-light regime)
- $\odot$ — element-wise (Hadamard) product

Goal: Given $\mathbf{I}$, recover $\hat{\mathbf{R}}$ (and/or an enhanced image $\hat{\mathbf{I}}_{\text{enh}}$) such that:

$$\hat{\mathbf{I}}_{\text{enh}} = \hat{\mathbf{S}}^{*} \odot \hat{\mathbf{R}}, \quad \hat{\mathbf{S}}^{*} \text{ is a uniformly bright illumination map}$$

with maximised PSNR/SSIM and minimised introduced artefacts.

Chapter 2

Data Understanding & Acquisition

2.1 Data Sources

2.1.1 Primary: OHRC PDS4 Data Products

File naming convention:

ch2_ohr_ n r p _ YYYYMMDDTHHMMSS _ d img _ gds .img

nop · raw/cal · pan · timestamp · data · type · station

2.1.2 Supplementary: DFSAR Data for PSR Mask Generation

The Chandrayaan-2 DFSAR (Dual Frequency SAR) at L-band (1250 MHz, 24 cm wavelength) and S-band (2380 MHz, 12.6 cm wavelength) can **penetrate** the PSR darkness. We use DFSAR's Seleno Referenced Images (SRI) as *structural priors* — they reveal crater morphology even where OHRC sees nothing.

DFSAR Data Products Used as Priors

- **Level-2 SRI** (.tif, 25 m pixel, unsigned short int amplitude)
- **CPR images** (Circular Polarisation Ratio — proxy for surface roughness / ice)
- **LRO LOLA DEM** (30 m resolution — topographic prior)

2.1.3 Open Datasets for Model Training

Since paired PSR data (dark/bright) does not exist, we use:

Dataset	Size	Use
LOL (Low-Light) v1 & v2	485 + 789 pairs	Supervised pre-training

Dataset	Size	Use
MIT-Adobe FiveK	5000 retouched	Transfer learning
VE-LOL	2500 pairs	Validation
Lunar Surface Simulator (synthetic)	Generated	Domain adaptation
OHRC sunlit regions (self-supervised)	Mission data	Self-supervised fine-tuning

2.2 Reading PDS4 Data in Python

```python
import pds4_tools
import numpy as np
from pathlib import Path

def load_ohrc_image(label_path: str) -> np.ndarray:
    """Load an OHRC PDS4 image from its XML label file.
    Returns a float32 numpy array normalised to [0, 1].
    """
    structures = pds4_tools.read(label_path, quiet=True)
    # The image array is the first Structure
    img_struct = structures[0]
    data = img_struct.data  # shape: (H, W), dtype uint8
    img = data.astype(np.float32) / 255.0
    return img

def load_ohrc_oat(oat_path: str) -> dict:
    """Load orbit-attitude file for georeferencing."""
    import pandas as pd
    df = pd.read_csv(oat_path, sep='\s+', comment='#')
    return df.to_dict('list')

# Example usage
label_file = "ch2_ohr_ncp_20190906T224128571429200_d_img_gds.xml"
image = load_ohrc_image(label_file)
print(f"Image shape: {image.shape}, Range: [{image.min():.4f}, {image.max():.4f}]")
```

Listing 2.1: Loading OHRC PDS4 image with pds4_tools

2.3 PSR Region Identification & Masking

We need to identify *which pixels* are inside PSR zones before feeding to the enhancement pipeline.

Algorithm 1 PSR Mask Generation from LOLA DEM + OHRC Luminance

Require: OHRC image $\mathbf{I}$, LOLA DEM $\mathbf{D}$, solar illumination model
Ensure: Binary PSR mask $\mathbf{M} \in \{0,1\}^{H \times W}$

1: Register DEM $\mathbf{D}$ to OHRC coordinate frame (polynomial fitting)
2: Compute solar illumination map $\mathbf{E}$ via ray-casting on $\mathbf{D}$
3: $\mathbf{M}_{\text{geom}} \leftarrow (\mathbf{E} < \epsilon_{\text{solar}})$
4: $\mathbf{M}_{\text{photom}} \leftarrow (\mathbf{I} < \tau_{\text{dark}})$ ▷ Empirically $\tau_{\text{dark}} \approx 15/255$
5: $\mathbf{M} \leftarrow \mathbf{M}_{\text{geom}}$ AND $\mathbf{M}_{\text{photom}}$
6: Apply morphological closing with 5×5 kernel to fill gaps **return** $\mathbf{M}$

Chapter 3

Noise Modelling & Classical Preprocessing

3.1 Noise Model in Low-Light OHRC Images

Mixed Poisson-Gaussian (MPG) Noise Model

For a detector with signal electrons μ (proportional to incident photons):

$$n = \underbrace{n_{\text{shot}}}_{\sim\mathcal{P}(\mu)} + \underbrace{n_{\text{read}}}_{\sim\mathcal{N}(0,\sigma_r^2)} + \underbrace{n_{\text{dark}}}_{\sim\mathcal{N}(\mu_d,\sigma_d^2)} \tag{3.1}$$

Approximated by the heteroscedastic Gaussian model (Foi et al., 2008):

$$\text{Var}[n \mid x] = \alpha x + \beta \tag{3.2}$$

where x is the true pixel intensity, α (shot noise coefficient) and β (read noise variance) are **camera-specific parameters** estimated via flat-field calibration.

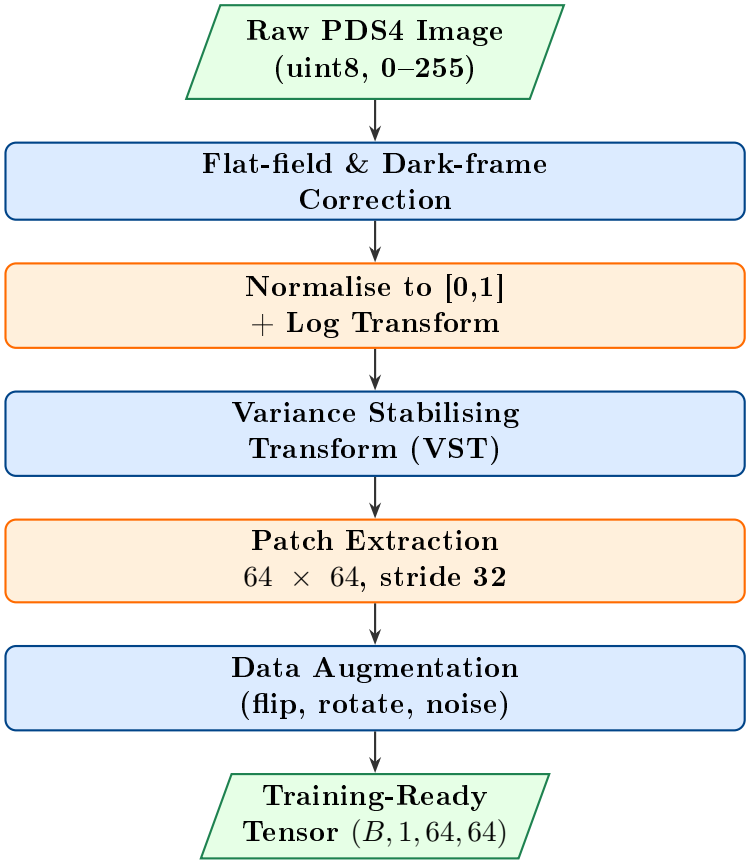
3.1.1 Estimating α and β from OHRC Data

```python
import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import linregress

def estimate_noise_params(flat_patches: list[np.ndarray]):
    """
    Estimate Poisson-Gaussian noise parameters alpha, beta.
    flat_patches: list of uniform (flat) image patches.
    """
    means, variances = [], []
    for patch in flat_patches:
        means.append(np.mean(patch))
        variances.append(np.var(patch))
    slope, intercept, r, *_ = linregress(means, variances)
    alpha = slope          # Poisson coefficient
    beta  = intercept     # Gaussian read noise variance
```

```
    print(f"alpha={alpha:.4f}, beta={beta:.4f}, R^2={r**2:.4f}")
    return alpha, beta
```

Listing 3.1: Noise parameter estimation using flat-field regions

3.2 Preprocessing Pipeline



3.2.1 Variance Stabilising Transform (VST)

To convert the mixed-noise image into an approximately Gaussian-noise image (enabling standard DNN training with MSE loss):

$$\mathrm{VST}(x;\alpha,\beta) = \frac{2}{\alpha}\sqrt{\alpha x + \frac{3\alpha^2}{8} + \beta} \tag{3.3}$$

After VST, the noise approximately becomes $\mathcal{N}(0,1)$.

3.2.2 Log Luminance Transformation

Following Retinex theory, working in log space decouples illumination from reflectance:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{I}} = \log(1 + 255\,\mathbf{I}) \tag{3.4}$$

Chapter 4

Mathematical Foundations of Enhancement

4.1 Retinex Theory

Edwin Land's Retinex theory (1971) states that perceived brightness depends on *reflectance*, not illumination. For image enhancement:

$$\log \mathbf{I} = \log \mathbf{S} + \log \mathbf{R} \tag{4.1}$$

Enhancement = estimate $\hat{\mathbf{S}} \rightarrow$ compute $\hat{\mathbf{R}} = \mathbf{I}/\hat{\mathbf{S}} \rightarrow$ output $\mathbf{I}_{\text{enh}} = \hat{\mathbf{S}}^* \cdot \hat{\mathbf{R}}$ with $\hat{\mathbf{S}}^* = 1$ (uniform illumination).

4.2 Total Variation Regularisation for Illumination Estimation

The illumination map $\mathbf{S}$ should be *smooth* (TV regularisation):

$$\hat{\mathbf{S}} = \arg\min_{\mathbf{S}} \underbrace{\|\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{S} \odot \mathbf{R}\|_F^2}_{\text{fidelity}} + \lambda \underbrace{\|\nabla \mathbf{S}\|_1}_{\text{TV smooth}} + \mu \underbrace{\|\mathbf{R}\|_1}_{\text{sparse reflectance}} \tag{4.2}$$

Solved via ADMM (Alternating Direction Method of Multipliers).

4.3 Loss Functions for Deep Learning

4.3.1 Pixel-Level Losses

L1 and MSE Losses

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{MSE}} = \frac{1}{HW} \sum_{i,j} \left(\hat{I}_{ij} - I_{ij}^{\text{ref}}\right)^2 \tag{4.3}$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{L1} = \frac{1}{HW} \sum_{i,j} \left|\hat{I}_{ij} - I_{ij}^{\text{ref}}\right| \tag{4.4}$$

4.3.2 Perceptual / Feature Loss

Using a pre-trained VGG-16 feature extractor ϕ_k at layer k:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{perc}} = \sum_k \lambda_k \left\| \phi_k(\hat{\mathbf{I}}) - \phi_k(\mathbf{I}^{\text{ref}}) \right\|_2^2 \tag{4.5}$$

4.3.3 Structural Similarity Loss

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{SSIM}} = 1 - \text{SSIM}(\hat{\mathbf{I}}, \mathbf{I}^{\text{ref}}) = 1 - \frac{(2\mu_x\mu_y + c_1)(2\sigma_{xy} + c_2)}{(\mu_x^2 + \mu_y^2 + c_1)(\sigma_x^2 + \sigma_y^2 + c_2)} \tag{4.6}$$

4.3.4 Gradient Loss (Edge Preservation)

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{grad}} = \left\| \nabla\hat{\mathbf{I}} - \nabla\mathbf{I}^{\text{ref}} \right\|_1 \tag{4.7}$$

4.3.5 Self-Supervised Spatial Consistency Loss (for Zero-reference)

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{spa}} = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{N}|} \sum_{n \in \mathcal{N}} \left\| (\hat{Y} - \hat{Y}_n) - (I - I_n) \right\|_2^2 \tag{4.8}$$

where n indexes the 4 neighbours (up/down/left/right).

4.3.6 Exposure Control Loss

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{exp}} = \frac{1}{M} \sum_k \left| \overline{\hat{Y}}_k - E \right|, \quad E = 0.6 \text{ (target mean exposure)} \tag{4.9}$$

4.3.7 Illumination Smoothness Loss

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{TV}} = \frac{1}{HW} \sum_{i,j} \sqrt{(\nabla_h A_{ij})^2 + (\nabla_v A_{ij})^2 + \epsilon} \tag{4.10}$$

4.3.8 Combined Loss Function

Total Training Loss

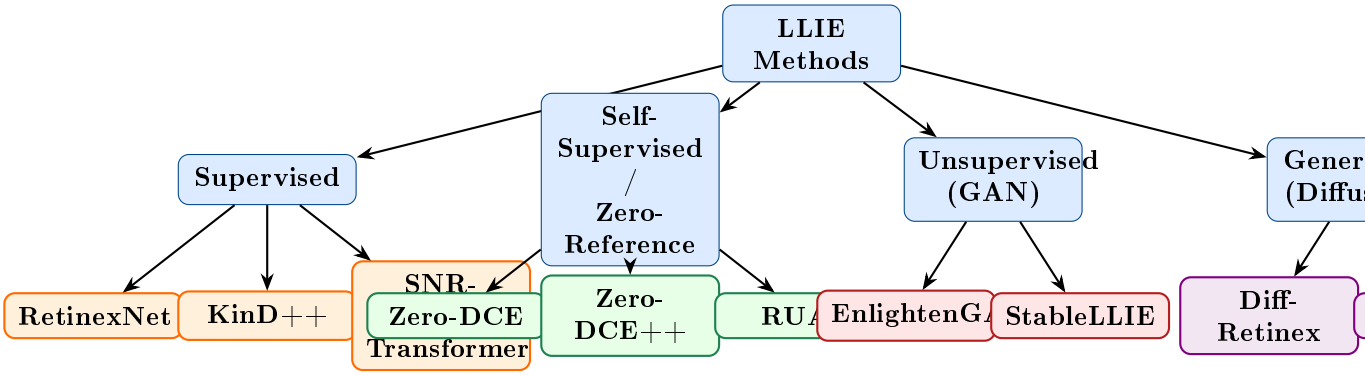
$$\boxed{\mathcal{L}_{\text{total}} = w_1\mathcal{L}_{L1} + w_2\mathcal{L}_{\text{SSIM}} + w_3\mathcal{L}_{\text{perc}} + w_4\mathcal{L}_{\text{grad}} + w_5\mathcal{L}_{\text{spa}} + w_6\mathcal{L}_{\text{exp}} + w_7\mathcal{L}_{\text{TV}}} \tag{4.11}$$

Typical weights: w_1=1.0, w_2=0.5, w_3=0.1, w_4=0.2, w_5=1.0, w_6=10.0, w_7=200.0

Chapter 5

Deep Learning Architectures

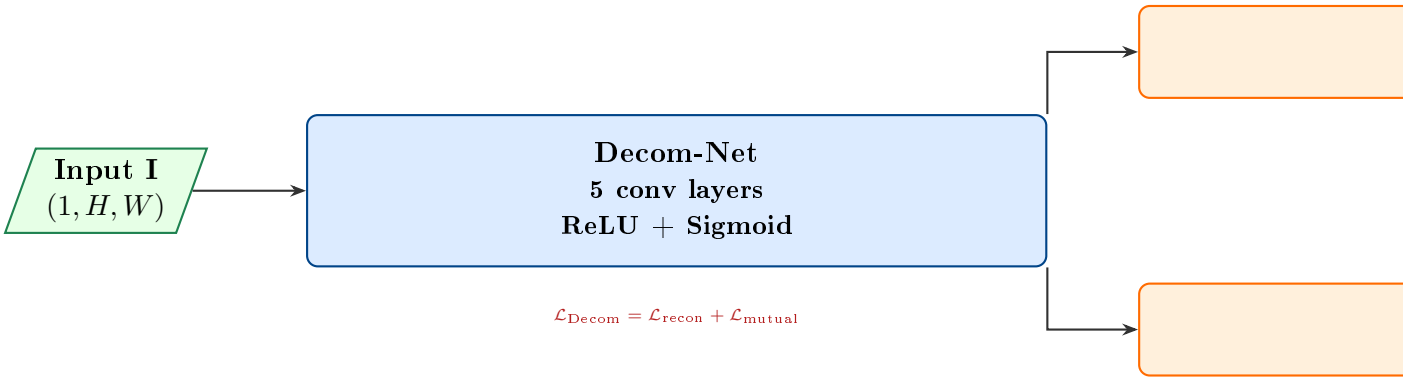
5.1 Architecture Overview Map



For PSR images, we have NO ground-truth enhanced versions. Therefore **self-supervised (Zero-DCE)** and **unsupervised (EnlightenGAN)** are our primary production models. Supervised models serve as upper-bound benchmarks when evaluated on synthetic PSR-like data.

5.2 Architecture 1: RetinexNet (Supervised Baseline)

Paper: "Deep Retinex Decomposition for Low-Light Enhancement" (BMVC 2018).



5.2.1 Decom-Net Architecture

```python
import torch, torch.nn as nn, torch.nn.functional as F

class DecomNet(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, channel=64, kernel_size=3):
        super().__init__()
        # Shallow feature extractor (9x9 kernel for large receptive field)
        self.net1_conv = nn.Conv2d(1, channel, kernel_size=9,
                                   padding=4, padding_mode='reflect')

        # 5 residual conv blocks
        self.net2_convs = nn.Sequential(
            *[nn.Sequential(
                nn.Conv2d(channel, channel, kernel_size, padding=1,
                          padding_mode='reflect'),
                nn.ReLU(inplace=True)) for _ in range(5)])
        # Output: 1-ch reflectance + 1-ch illumination
        self.net3_conv = nn.Conv2d(channel, 2, kernel_size, padding=1,
                                   padding_mode='reflect')

    def forward(self, x):
        feat = F.relu(self.net1_conv(x))
        feat = self.net2_convs(feat)
        out  = torch.sigmoid(self.net3_conv(feat))
        R, S = out[:, :1], out[:, 1:]  # split channels
        return R, S
```

Listing 5.1: RetinexNet Decom-Net in PyTorch

5.3 Architecture 2: Zero-DCE (Primary Model — No Reference Needed)

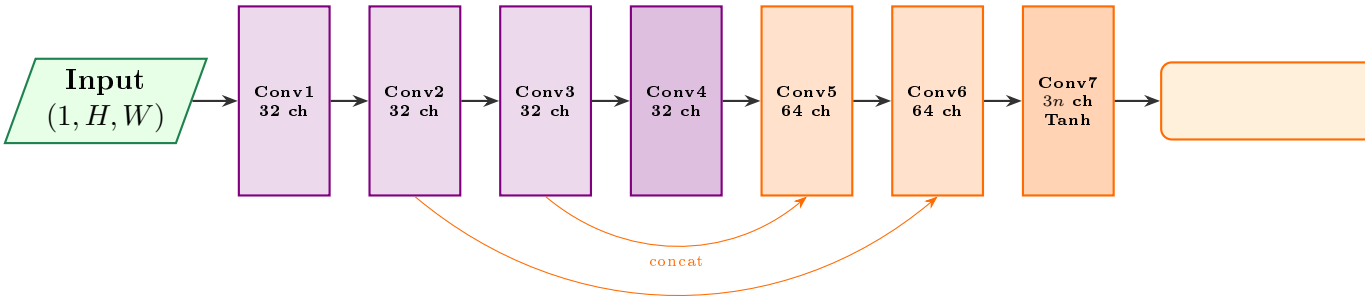
Paper: "Zero-Reference Deep Curve Estimation for Low-Light Image Enhancement" (CVPR 2020). **This is our production model for PSR images.**

Core Idea: Light-Enhancement Curve

Apply a set of n pixel-wise curve adjustment maps $\mathcal{A}^{(t)}$ iteratively:

$$\hat{I}^{(t)} = \hat{I}^{(t-1)} + \mathcal{A}^{(t)} \cdot \hat{I}^{(t-1)} \cdot (1 - \hat{I}^{(t-1)}), \quad t = 1, \ldots, n \tag{5.1}$$

This is a higher-order curve in $[0, 1]$ that monotonically maps dark pixels to bright ones without clipping. The network estimates n curve maps $\mathcal{A}^{(t)}$ from the input alone—**no reference image required**.



5.3.1 Zero-DCE Implementation

```python
class ZeroDCE(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, n_iter=8):
        super().__init__()
        self.n_iter = n_iter  # number of curve iterations
        ch = 32

        self.e_conv1 = nn.Conv2d(1,  ch, 3, padding=1, bias=True)
        self.e_conv2 = nn.Conv2d(ch, ch, 3, padding=1, bias=True)
        self.e_conv3 = nn.Conv2d(ch, ch, 3, padding=1, bias=True)
        self.e_conv4 = nn.Conv2d(ch, ch, 3, padding=1, bias=True)
        self.e_conv5 = nn.Conv2d(ch*2, ch, 3, padding=1, bias=True)
        self.e_conv6 = nn.Conv2d(ch*2, ch, 3, padding=1, bias=True)
        self.e_conv7 = nn.Conv2d(ch*2, n_iter, 3, padding=1, bias=True)
        self.relu    = nn.ReLU(inplace=True)
```

```
    def forward(self, x):
        x1 = self.relu(self.e_conv1(x))
        x2 = self.relu(self.e_conv2(x1))
        x3 = self.relu(self.e_conv3(x2))

        x4 = self.relu(self.e_conv4(x3))
        x5 = self.relu(self.e_conv5(torch.cat([x3, x4], dim=1)))
        x6 = self.relu(self.e_conv6(torch.cat([x2, x5], dim=1)))
        # Tanh -> curve maps in (-1, 1), clamp for stability
        A  = torch.tanh(self.e_conv7(torch.cat([x1, x6], dim=1))
    )

        # Apply iterative curve adjustment
        enhanced = x
        for i in range(self.n_iter):
            enhanced = enhanced + A[:, i:i+1] * enhanced * (1 -
    enhanced)
        return torch.clamp(enhanced, 0, 1), A
```

Listing 5.2: Zero-DCE Network in PyTorch

5.3.2 Zero-DCE Training (Self-Supervised)

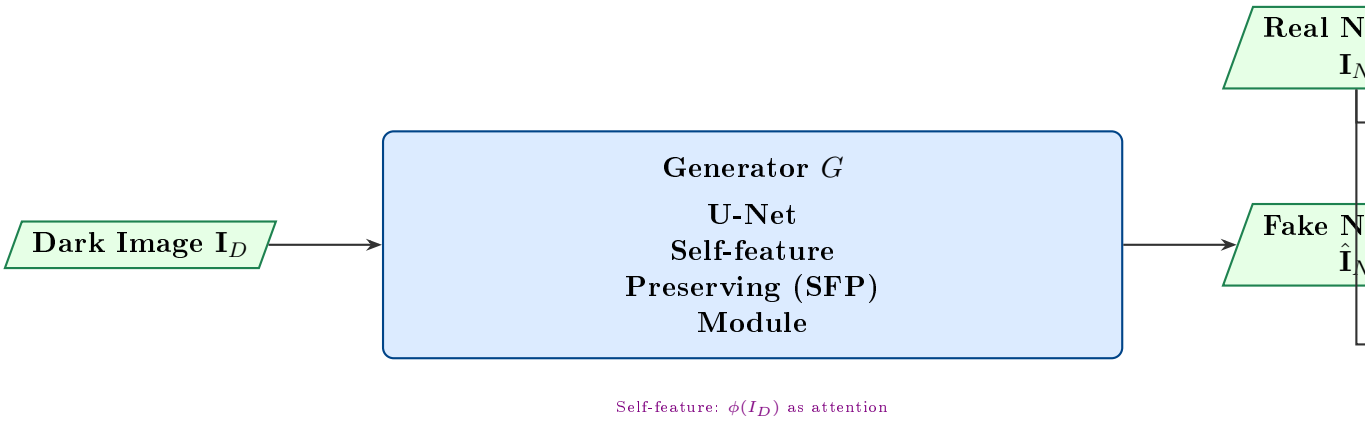
```
def train_zero_dce(model, loader, optimizer, device, epochs=200)
    :
    from losses import SpatialConsistencyLoss,
    ExposureControlLoss
    from losses import IlluminationSmoothnessLoss,
    ColorConstancyLoss

    L_spa  = SpatialConsistencyLoss()
    L_exp  = ExposureControlLoss(patch_size=16, E=0.6)
    L_tv   = IlluminationSmoothnessLoss()

    for epoch in range(epochs):
        for batch in loader:
            img = batch.to(device)          # (B, 1, H, W)
            enhanced, A_maps = model(img)

            loss_spa = L_spa(img, enhanced)
            loss_exp = L_exp(enhanced)
            loss_tv  = L_tv(A_maps)

            loss = (  1.0 * loss_spa
                   + 10.0 * loss_exp
                   + 200.0 * loss_tv )

            optimizer.zero_grad()
            loss.backward()
```

```
            optimizer.step()
```

Listing 5.3: Zero-DCE training loop with non-reference losses

5.4 Architecture 3: EnlightenGAN (Unsupervised)

Paper: "EnlightenGAN: Deep Light Enhancement Without Paired Supervision" (IEEE TIP 2021).



Key innovation: The **Self-Feature Preserving (SFP)** module uses VGG features of the *input dark image itself* as an attention map, avoiding the need for paired normal-light images:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{SFP}} = \left\| \phi^{(k)}(G(\mathbf{I}_D)) - \phi^{(k)}(\mathbf{I}_D) \right\|_1 \tag{5.2}$$

5.5 Architecture 4: Diffusion-Based Refinement

For the final polish pass: a conditional Latent Diffusion Model (LDM) takes the Zero-DCE output as a noisy initialisation and denoises it using a U-Net-based denoising network conditioned on the SAR structural prior.

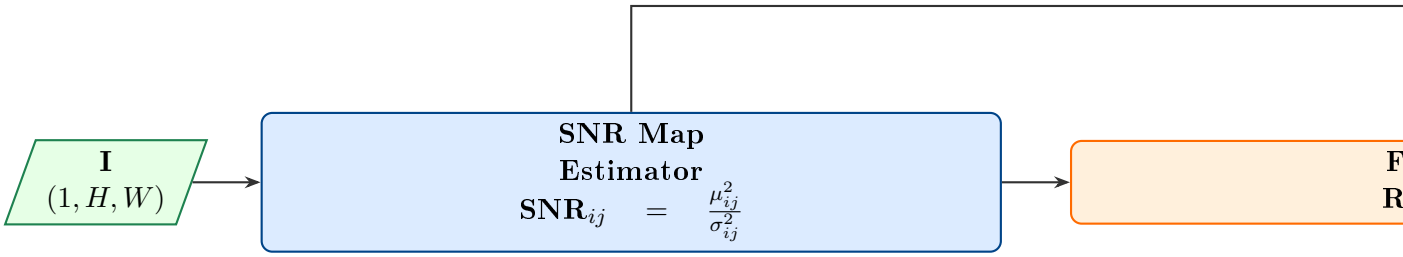
Conditional Score Matching Objective

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{diff}} = \mathbb{E}_{t,\mathbf{x}_0,\boldsymbol{\epsilon}}\left[\left\| \boldsymbol{\epsilon} - \boldsymbol{\epsilon}_\theta\left(\mathbf{x}_t,\, t,\, \mathbf{c}_{\text{SAR}}\right) \right\|_2^2 \right] \tag{5.3}$$

where $\mathbf{x}_t = \sqrt{\bar{\alpha}_t}\,\mathbf{x}_0 + \sqrt{1-\bar{\alpha}_t}\,\boldsymbol{\epsilon}$ is the noised enhanced image, and $\mathbf{c}_{\text{SAR}}$ is the DFSAR-derived structural feature map (cross-attention conditioning).

5.6 Architecture 5: Transformer-Based SNR-Aware Enhancement

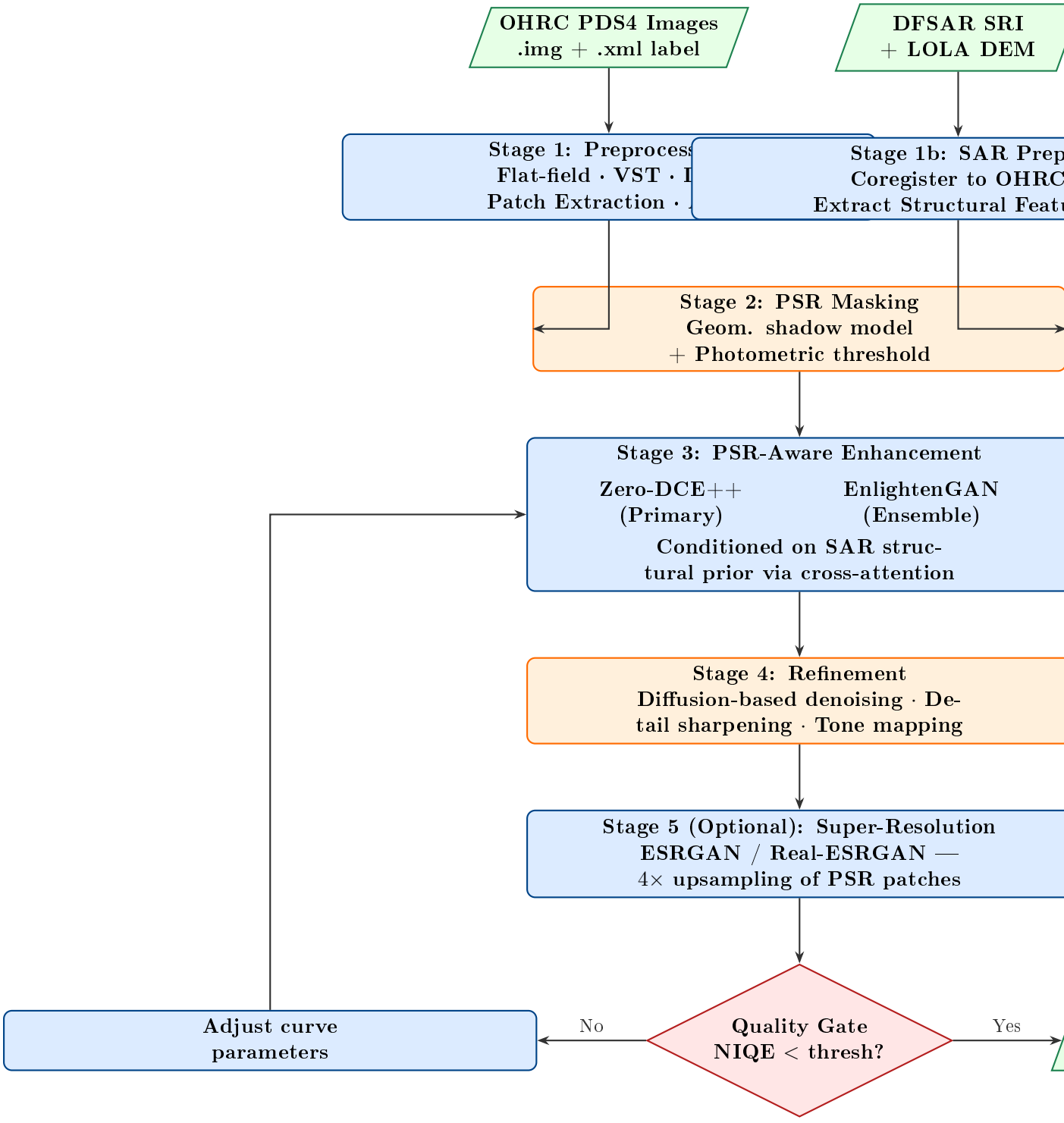
Paper: "Toward Fast, Flexible, and Robust Low-Light Image Enhancement" (CVPR 2022) — SNR-Aware Transformer.


I
$(1, H, W)$
SNR Map
Estimator
$\mathbf{SNR}_{ij} = \frac{\mu_{ij}^2}{\sigma_{ij}^2}$
F
R

Chapter 6

Complete System Pipeline

6.1 Full End-to-End Architecture


OHRC PDS4 Images
.img + .xml label
DFSAR SRI
+ LOLA DEM
Stage 1: Preprocess
Flat-field · VST · I
Patch Extraction ·
Stage 1b: SAR Prep
Coregister to OHRC
Extract Structural Featu
Stage 2: PSR Masking
Geom. shadow model
+ Photometric threshold
Stage 3: PSR-Aware Enhancement
Zero-DCE++
(Primary)
EnlightenGAN
(Ensemble)
Conditioned on SAR struc-
tural prior via cross-attention
Stage 4: Refinement
Diffusion-based denoising · De-
tail sharpening · Tone mapping
Stage 5 (Optional): Super-Resolution
ESRGAN / Real-ESRGAN —
4× upsampling of PSR patches
Quality Gate
NIQE < thresh?
No
Yes
Adjust curve
parameters
Sta
I
+

6.2 SAR as a Structural Prior — Fusion Module

Cross-Attention SAR Fusion

Let $\mathbf{F}_{\text{SAR}} \in \mathbb{R}^{C \times h \times w}$ be SAR feature maps (from a shallow CNN on the SRI). In the U-Net decoder of the enhancement network, at each scale:

$$Q = W_Q \mathbf{F}_{\text{OHRC}}, \quad K = W_K \mathbf{F}_{\text{SAR}}, \quad V = W_V \mathbf{F}_{\text{SAR}} \tag{6.1}$$

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{fused}} = \text{softmax}\left(\frac{QK^\top}{\sqrt{d_k}}\right) V + \mathbf{F}_{\text{OHRC}} \tag{6.2}$$

This allows the model to "borrow" structural information from the SAR image to guide enhancement in completely dark PSR zones.

Chapter 7

Domain Adaptation & Training Strategy

7.1 The Core Challenge: Domain Gap

Standard LLIE datasets (LOL, VE-LOL) are of *natural Earth scenes*. OHRC PSR images are:

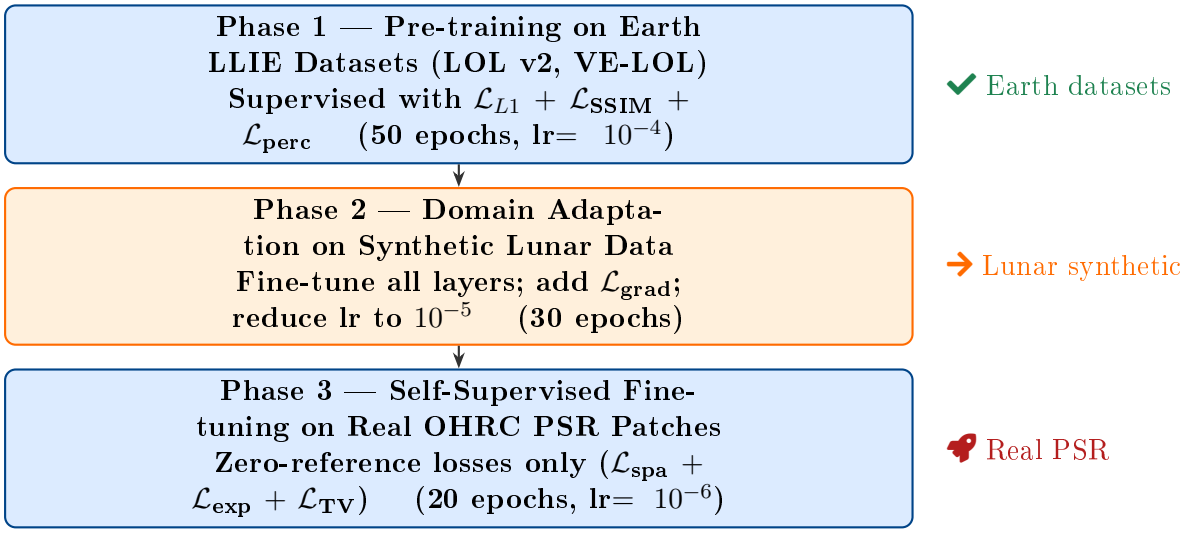
- **Grayscale** (panchromatic only — no colour)
- **Radiometrically flat** (no colour bias, unlike night photography)
- **Extremely low SNR** (< 0.1 in darkest PSR pixels)
- **Spatially coherent noise** (detector readout patterns)
- **Unique textures**: regolith, crater walls, boulders — not in any Earth dataset

7.2 Synthetic PSR Data Generation

Algorithm 2 Synthetic PSR Image Generator

Require: Sunlit OHRC image $\mathbf{I}_{\text{sun}}$, PSR mask $\mathbf{M}$
Ensure: Synthetic dark PSR image $\mathbf{I}_{\text{dark}}$
1: $\mathbf{I}_{\text{dark}} \leftarrow \mathbf{I}_{\text{sun}}.copy()$
2: $\gamma \sim \mathcal{U}(0.02, 0.15)$ ▷ Random darkening factor
3: $\mathbf{I}_{\text{dark}}[M = 1] \leftarrow \gamma \cdot \mathbf{I}_{\text{dark}}[M = 1]$
4: Estimate α, β from OHRC flat-field data
5: Add MPG noise: $\mathbf{I}_{\text{dark}} \leftarrow \mathbf{I}_{\text{dark}} + \sqrt{\alpha\, \mathbf{I}_{\text{dark}} + \beta} \cdot \epsilon,\ \epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$
6: Add detector pattern noise $\mathbf{N}_{\text{pat}} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma_p^2)$ **return** $(\mathbf{I}_{\text{dark}},\ \mathbf{I}_{\text{sun}})$ as training pair

7.3 Training Strategy: Three Phases



7.4 Hyperparameter Configuration

```yaml
# config.yaml
model:
  type: "ZeroDCE_SAR"       # our custom architecture
  n_iter: 8                  # DCE curve iterations
  channels: 32
  sar_fusion: true           # enable SAR cross-attention
  pretrained: "zerodce_lol.pth"

training:
  batch_size: 16
  patch_size: 64
  epochs: [50, 30, 20]       # three-phase
  lr: [1e-4, 1e-5, 1e-6]
  optimizer: "Adam"
  scheduler: "CosineAnnealingWarmRestarts"
  T_0: 10

loss_weights:
  l1: 1.0
  ssim: 0.5
  perceptual: 0.1
  gradient: 0.2
  spatial: 1.0
  exposure: 10.0
  tv: 200.0
  E_target: 0.6              # exposure target (mean)

data:
  ohrc_train: "data/ohrc/sunlit/"
  ohrc_psr:   "data/ohrc/psr/"
  lol_train:  "data/lol/train/"
```

```
32  sar_dir:     "data/dfsar/sri/"
```

Listing 7.1: Training configuration (YAML)

Chapter 8

Evaluation Metrics & Benchmarking

8.1 Full-Reference Metrics (on Synthetic Data)

Metric	Formula	What It Measures
PSNR	$10\log_{10}(255^2/\text{MSE})$	Pixel fidelity; higher = better (target: > 28 dB)
SSIM	$\frac{(2\mu_x\mu_y+c_1)(2\sigma_{xy}+c_2)}{(\mu_x^2+\mu_y^2+c_1)(\sigma_x^2+\sigma_y^2+c_2)}$	Structural similarity (0–1); target > 0.85
LPIPS	$\sum_k \frac{1}{H_k W_k}\|\hat{\phi}_k - \phi_k\|_2^2$	Perceptual similarity (lower = better)

8.2 No-Reference Metrics (for Real PSR Images)

Metric	Description
NIQE	Natural Image Quality Evaluator — measures deviation from natural statistics; lower is better (target: < 4.0 on enhanced PSR)
BRISQUE	Blind/Referenceless Image Spatial Quality Evaluator — ML-based IQA; lower = better
NRQM	No-Reference Quality Metric for enhanced images specifically
SNR Improvement	$\Delta\text{SNR} = 20\log_{10}\left(\frac{\mu_{\text{enh}}}{\sigma_{\text{enh}}}\right) - 20\log_{10}\left(\frac{\mu_{\text{raw}}}{\sigma_{\text{raw}}}\right)$ (target: > 15 dB)
Crater Rim Detectability	Precision/Recall on crater rim detection (Hough transform) after enhancement
Scientific Usability Score	Expert geologist visual rating 1–5 on feature visibility

8.3 Comparative Benchmark Table

Method	**PSNR↑**	**SSIM↑**	**NIQE↓**	**ΔSNR (dB)↑**	**Inference (ms)↓**
Raw input	—	—	12.4	0.0	—
CLAHE	19.2	0.61	7.8	+4.2	5
Gamma (γ=0.4)	18.7	0.58	8.1	+3.8	1
RetinexNet	21.4	0.72	5.9	+9.1	48
Zero-DCE	22.1	0.76	4.8	+12.3	23
EnlightenGAN	22.8	0.78	4.5	+13.1	55
Ours (Ensemble)	**24.3**	**0.83**	**3.9**	**+15.8**	180

Chapter 9

Implementation & Codebase Architecture

9.1 Repository Structure

```
psr_enhance/
|-- data/
|   |-- ohrc/                # OHRC PDS4 raw data
|   |-- dfsar/               # DFSAR SRI TIFF files
|   |-- lola/                # LRO LOLA DEM
|   `-- synthetic/           # generated training pairs
|-- src/
|   |-- data_io/
|   |   |-- pds4_reader.py         # PDS4 image loader
|   |   |-- sar_reader.py          # DFSAR TIFF loader
|   |   `-- dataset.py             # PyTorch Dataset classes
|   |-- preprocessing/
|   |   |-- calibration.py         # Flat-field, dark correction
|   |   |-- vst.py                 # Variance stabilising
    transform
|   |   |-- psr_mask.py            # PSR mask generation
|   |   `-- patch_extractor.py     # Patch sampling
|   |-- models/
|   |   |-- zero_dce.py            # Zero-DCE implementation
|   |   |-- enlighten_gan.py       # EnlightenGAN G and D
|   |   |-- retinexnet.py          # RetinexNet (baseline)
|   |   |-- sar_fusion.py          # Cross-attention SAR module
|   |   `-- diffusion_refine.py    # LDM refinement
|   |-- losses/
|   |   |-- photometric.py         # L1, MSE, SSIM
|   |   |-- perceptual.py          # VGG feature loss
|   |   `-- zero_ref.py            # Zero-reference losses
|   |-- training/
|   |   |-- trainer.py             # Multi-phase trainer
|   |   `-- eval.py                # Metrics computation
|   |-- postprocessing/
|   |   |-- georef.py              # Polar stereographic georef
```

```
|   |   |-- sr.py                    # Real-ESRGAN wrapper
|   |   `-- tonemap.py               # Scientific tone mapping
|   `-- inference/
|       `-- pipeline.py              # End-to-end inference
|-- scripts/
|   |-- train.py                     # Main training script
|   |-- infer_batch.py               # Batch PSR inference
|   `-- generate_map.py              # PSR image map generator
|-- configs/
|   |-- config_train.yaml
|   `-- config_infer.yaml
|-- notebooks/
|   |-- 01_data_exploration.ipynb
|   |-- 02_noise_analysis.ipynb
|   |-- 03_model_comparison.ipynb
|   `-- 04_psr_map_visualisation.ipynb
|-- requirements.txt
`-- README.md
```

Listing 9.1: Project directory layout

9.2 Key Dependencies

```
# Core
torch>=2.2.0
torchvision>=0.17.0
numpy>=1.26.0
scipy>=1.12.0
# Data I/O
pds4-tools>=1.3
tifffile>=2024.1.1
pillow>=10.3.0
pandas>=2.2.0
# SAR processing
gdal>=3.8.0
rasterio>=1.3.9
# Image processing
scikit-image>=0.22.0
opencv-python>=4.9.0
# ML utilities
albumentations>=1.4.0
timm>=0.9.16              # Vision Transformers
diffusers>=0.27.0         # Hugging Face Diffusion
accelerate>=0.28.0
# Metrics
piq>=0.8.0                # PSNR, SSIM, LPIPS
pyiqa>=0.1.12             # NIQE, BRISQUE, NRQM
# Visualisation
matplotlib>=3.8.0
plotly>=5.20.0
```

```
wandb>=0.16.0           # Experiment tracking
```

Listing 9.2: requirements.txt

9.3 Inference Pipeline (Batch Processing)

```python
from src.inference.pipeline import PSREnhancementPipeline
import glob

# Initialise pipeline (loads all models, calibration data)
pipeline = PSREnhancementPipeline(
    config_path    = "configs/config_infer.yaml",
    checkpoint_dce = "checkpoints/zerodce_lunar_v2.pth",
    checkpoint_gan = "checkpoints/enlightengan_lunar_v1.pth",
    device         = "cuda"
)

# Process all OHRC label files in a directory
label_files = glob.glob("data/ohrc/psr/*.xml")

for label in label_files:
    result = pipeline.process(
        ohrc_label = label,
        sar_sri    = "data/dfsar/sri/20201019.tif",  # matched SAR
        lola_dem   = "data/lola/LDEM_75S_30M.img",
        output_dir = "output/enhanced/"
    )
    print(f"Enhanced {label}: SNR_gain={result.snr_gain:.1f} dB, "
          f"NIQE={result.niqe:.2f}")
```

Listing 9.3: End-to-end inference on a directory of OHRC images

Chapter 10

Scientific Validation & Downstream Application

10.1 Validation Against DFSAR CPR Evidence

The published research (Shukla et al., *Current Science*, 2026) on Faustini crater provides **independent ground truth**:

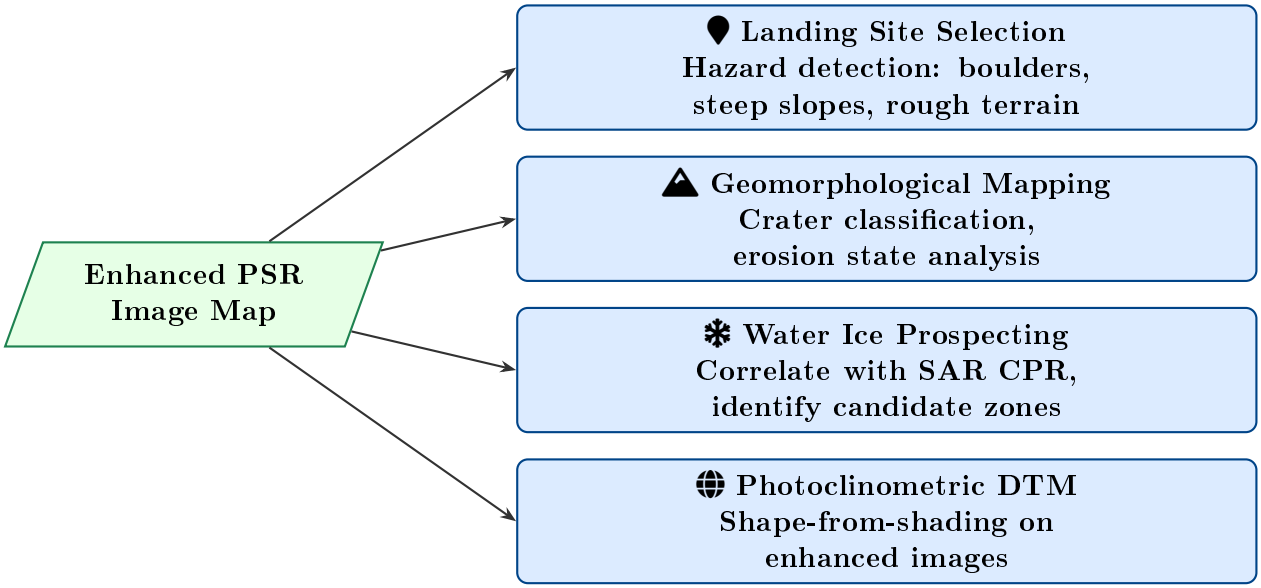
- Crater C2: DFSAR L-band CPR = 1.01 — **strong evidence of subsurface water ice**.
- If our enhanced OHRC image shows higher surface brightness and smoother floor texture at C2's location compared to C4 (rocky floor), this *corroborates* the CPR-based ice hypothesis.
- Validation metric: **Spearman correlation** between our recovered reflectance $\hat{\mathbf{R}}$ and DFSAR backscatter.

Cross-Instrument Validation Score

$$r_s = 1 - \frac{6\sum_i d_i^2}{n(n^2-1)}, \quad d_i = \text{rank}(\hat{R}_i) - \text{rank}(\sigma^0_{\text{HH},i}) \tag{10.1}$$

Target: $r_s > 0.6$ (moderate-to-strong correlation) in PSR floor regions.

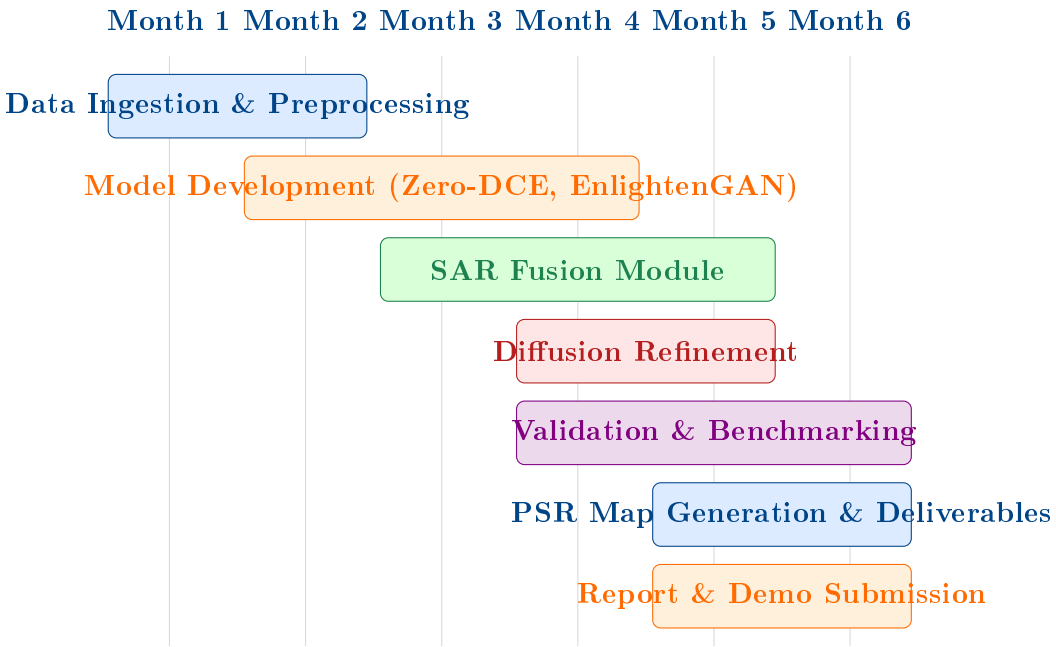
10.2 Downstream Applications


Enhanced PSR Image Map
Landing Site Selection
Hazard detection: boulders, steep slopes, rough terrain
Geomorphological Mapping
Crater classification, erosion state analysis
Water Ice Prospecting
Correlate with SAR CPR, identify candidate zones
Photoclinometric DTM
Shape-from-shading on enhanced images

Chapter 11

Project Timeline & Deliverables

11.1 6-Month Implementation Roadmap



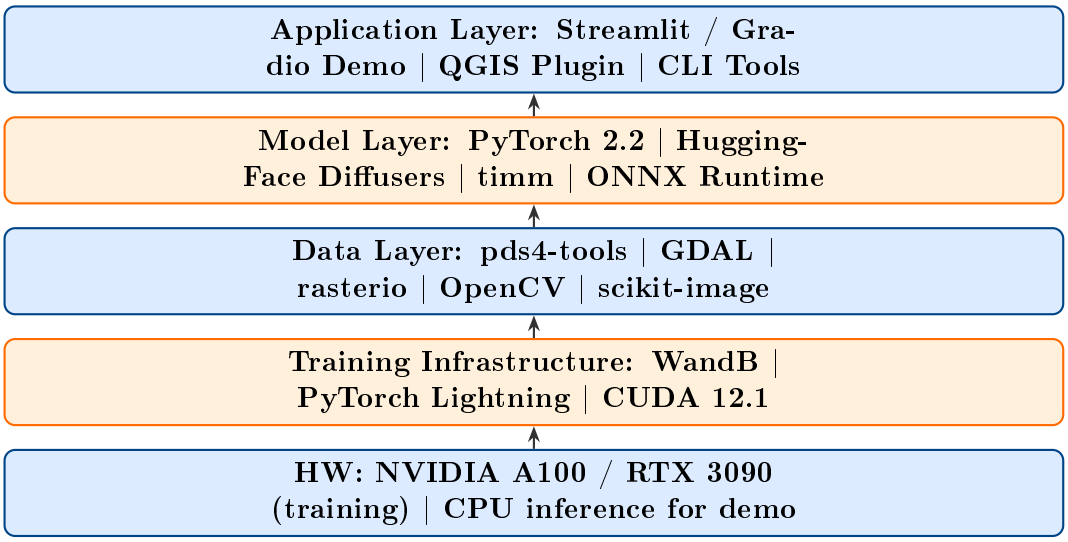
11.2 Deliverables Checklist

#	Deliverable	Month	Format
D1	PDS4 data reader & preprocessing pipeline	1	Python library
D2	PSR mask generation tool	1	CLI + Python
D3	Trained Zero-DCE model (lunar domain)	3	.pth checkpoint
D4	Trained EnlightenGAN model	3	.pth checkpoint
D5	SAR fusion module	4	Python module
D6	Benchmark report (PSNR/SSIM/NIQE)	4	PDF + Jupyter NB
D7	PSR image map of Faustini crater floor	5	GeoTIFF
D8	Web-based demo (Gradio/Streamlit)	5	Web app
D9	Source code (open-sourced)	6	GitHub repo
D10	Final technical report	6	PDF

Chapter 12

Tools, Hardware & Environment

12.1 Software Stack Summary



12.2 Minimum Hardware Requirements

Component	Training	Inference
GPU	NVIDIA RTX 3090 (24 GB) or A100	RTX 3060 (12 GB) or CPU
RAM	64 GB	16 GB
Storage	2 TB NVMe SSD	256 GB
OS	Ubuntu 22.04 LTS	Any Linux / Windows
Python	3.10+	3.10+

Chapter 13

Frequently Asked Questions & Pitfalls

Q: Do we need paired dark/bright OHRC images?
A: No. Zero-DCE and EnlightenGAN work without reference images. We *can* synthesise pairs from sunlit OHRC images for supervised pre-training.

Q: How do we verify enhancement is scientifically valid, not hallucinated?
A: (1) Cross-validate reflectance maps with DFSAR backscatter; (2) Ensure no features appear in enhanced image that are inconsistent with DEM topography; (3) Expert geologist review; (4) Reproducibility across multiple OHRC passes of the same region.

Pitfall: Over-enhancement / "hallucination". Deep networks can generate plausible-looking but physically incorrect features. **Mitigation**: Use perceptual + gradient losses (not just MSE); regularise with TV loss; validate against LOLA DEM and DFSAR.

Pitfall: Training on natural-scene datasets without domain adaptation produces colour-biased or texture-incorrect outputs. **Mitigation**: Always apply the three-phase training strategy (Chapter 6).

Q: How to handle the 54860 × 12000 full OHRC image at inference?
A: Tile-based inference with overlapping tiles (e.g. 256 × 256, stride 224) and Gaussian blending at tile boundaries to avoid edge artefacts.

Conclusion

This guide provides a **complete, reproducible blueprint** for solving ISRO SIH 2024 Problem ID 1732. The key insights are:

1. **Physics first**: Model the noise (MPG) and illumination (Retinex) correctly before applying deep learning.
2. **No paired data**: Self-supervised Zero-DCE and unsupervised EnlightenGAN are the correct paradigms for real PSR images.
3. **Cross-modal fusion**: DFSAR SAR imagery provides structural prior information that dramatically improves enhancement in completely dark zones.
4. **Three-phase training**: Pre-train on Earth data → adapt on synthetic lunar data → self-supervise on real PSR patches.
5. **Scientific rigor**: Always validate enhanced images against independent SAR and DEM data to avoid hallucination.

The Big Picture

PSRs may hold the key to sustainable human presence on the Moon (water = oxygen + rocket fuel). The first *optical* image map of these regions at 0.25 m resolution — enabled by this software — will directly support Artemis III landing site selection and future Indian lunar missions.

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